

Travel Claim and Expense Submission Policy

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Department: Finance Operations

Process Area: Travel Permit and Expense Claims

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Document Owner: Finance Control Unit

1. Purpose

This policy defines the required procedure for submitting, reviewing, approving, and reimbursing employee travel-related expenses. The policy applies to all employees who travel for official business purposes and submit claims through the organization's ERP-based travel and finance process.

The objective of this policy is to ensure that all travel claims are accurate, properly supported by evidence, approved by the correct authority, and recorded in the finance system before reimbursement is made.

2. Scope

This policy applies to the following travel-related expense categories:

- Domestic business travel
- International business travel
- Prepaid travel expenses

- Accommodation expenses
- Meal allowances
- Local transport and taxi charges
- Air tickets, train tickets, and bus tickets
- Visa, permit, and official travel documentation costs
- Other approved business travel expenses

This policy does not apply to personal travel, non-business expenses, entertainment expenses without approval, or expenses that are not supported by valid documentation.

3. Travel Request Requirement

Before an employee begins official travel, a travel permit or travel request must be created in the ERP system. The request must include:

- Employee name and employee ID
- Department or cost center
- Travel destination
- Travel purpose
- Start date and end date
- Estimated travel cost
- Budget number or project code
- Required approval authority

Travel expenses submitted without a valid travel request or travel permit may be rejected unless exceptional approval is provided by the Finance Manager.

4. Claim Submission Rules

Employees must submit travel claims within 14 calendar days after completing the travel. Late submissions require a justification and may require additional approval.

Each travel claim must include:

- Claim reference number
- Related travel permit number
- Employee ID
- Expense date
- Expense category
- Claimed amount
- Currency
- Receipt or invoice reference
- Business justification
- Cost center or budget code

Claims must be submitted through the ERP system. Email-based or paper-based submissions are not accepted unless the ERP system is temporarily unavailable.

5. Supporting Documents

The following supporting documents are required:

- Hotel invoice for accommodation claims
- Transport receipt for taxi, train, bus, or parking claims

- Air ticket invoice and boarding pass for flight claims
- Meal receipt if actual meal cost is claimed
- Visa or permit receipt where applicable
- Approved travel permit for all travel-related claims

Scanned documents must be clear and readable. If the receipt is unclear, incomplete, or missing, the Finance Officer may request clarification or reject the claim.

6. Approval Workflow

The standard approval workflow is as follows:

Step 1: Employee submits travel claim.

Step 2: Line Manager reviews business purpose and confirms travel relevance.

Step 3: Budget Owner verifies budget availability.

Step 4: Finance Officer validates receipts, amounts, tax details, and policy compliance.

Step 5: Finance Manager approves reimbursement.

Step 6: Payment Officer schedules payment.

Claims below LKR 25,000 may be approved by the Line Manager and Finance Officer. Claims between LKR 25,000 and LKR 100,000 require Budget Owner approval. Claims above LKR 100,000 require Finance Manager approval.

7. Reimbursable Expenses

The following expenses may be reimbursed if approved and supported by valid documentation:

- Accommodation within approved rate limits
- Transportation directly related to business travel
- Meals within the daily allowance limit
- Official communication charges during travel
- Visa and permit processing fees
- Conference or business meeting registration fees
- Approved emergency travel expenses

8. Non-Reimbursable Expenses

The following expenses are not reimbursable:

- Personal shopping
- Alcohol and tobacco
- Fines and penalties
- Entertainment without prior approval
- Expenses incurred by family members
- Luxury upgrades not approved in advance
- Duplicate claims
- Expenses without valid receipts

9. Currency Conversion

For foreign currency claims, the ERP system must record both the original currency amount and the converted local currency amount. The exchange rate must be based on the

organization's approved finance rate for the transaction date or the bank card settlement rate where evidence is provided.

10. Duplicate Claim Control

The ERP system must check for duplicate claims using:

- Employee ID
- Receipt number
- Expense date
- Vendor name
- Claimed amount
- Travel permit number

If a possible duplicate is detected, the claim must be flagged for manual finance review.

11. Payment Processing

Approved travel claims are transferred to the reimbursement queue. Payments are normally processed within 7 working days after final approval. Delays may occur if supporting documents are incomplete or if the claim requires additional verification.

12. Audit and Compliance

Finance Operations may audit travel claims at any time. Employees must retain original receipts for at least 6 months after reimbursement. Fraudulent claims may result in disciplinary action and recovery of paid amounts.

13. ERP Data Requirements

The ERP system must store the following data for each travel claim:

- Case ID
- Claim ID
- Employee ID
- Department
- Cost center
- Travel permit reference
- Activity history
- Approval timestamps
- Claimed amount
- Approved amount
- Rejected amount, if applicable
- Payment status
- Document references
- Audit notes

14. Policy Exception Handling

Any exception to this policy must be recorded in the ERP system with justification and approval from the Finance Manager. Exceptions must not be handled outside the system.

15. Review Cycle

This policy must be reviewed annually by the Finance Control Unit and updated when there are changes to travel, reimbursement, tax, or internal control requirements.